

SCULPTURE, POTTERY AND ICONOGRAPHY

SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL → LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL → POTTERY CHRONOLOGY → THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX → ANICONIC TO ICONIC → GUPTA BRIDGE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL

SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL

WHAT CARVING OR CASTING PERMITS

POSTURE + ATTRIBUTE

IDENTITY AND ACTION

PATRON + SITE

COMMISSIONED CONTEXT

SIMILARITY, DIFFERENCE AND LIMIT

CORE CLAIM

- MATERIAL → what carving or casting permits
- POSTURE + ATTRIBUTE → identity and action

MECHANISM

- PATRON + SITE → commissioned context
- COMPARISON → similarity, difference and limit

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MATERIAL → what carving or casting permits
- POSTURE + ATTRIBUTE → identity and action

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PATRON + SITE → commissioned context; COMPARISON → similarity, difference and limit.

01

STAGE 01

LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL

LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL

WAX MODEL

CLAY INVESTMENT

WAX LEAVES A CAVITY

MOLTEN METAL

BRONZE FORM

SEPARATE FROM A MUSEUM LABEL

CORE CLAIM

- WAX MODEL → clay investment
- HEAT → wax leaves a cavity

MECHANISM

- MOLTEN METAL → bronze form
- MEANING → separate from a museum label

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- WAX MODEL → clay investment
- HEAT → wax leaves a cavity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MOLTEN METAL → bronze form; MEANING → separate from a museum label.

02

STAGE 02

POTTERY CHRONOLOGY

POTTERY CHRONOLOGY

COARSE HAND-MADE WARE

AHAR, MALWA AND JORWE PAINTED WARES

SEPARATE CHRONOLOGICAL MARKERS

FINE EARLY HISTORIC TABLEWARE

CORE CLAIM

- NEOLITHIC → coarse hand-made ware
- CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares

MECHANISM

- HARAPPAN / PGW → separate chronological markers
- NBPW → fine early historic tableware

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NEOLITHIC → coarse hand-made ware
- CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares.

03

STAGE 03

THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

GREY STONE, BUDDHIST, LAYERED INFLUENCE

RED STONE, THREE RELIGIONS, ATTRIBUTES

LIMESTONE, BUDDHIST NARRATIVE, TRIBHANGA

COMPARE ON THE SAME AXES

CORE CLAIM

GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

MECHANISM

AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga

RULE → compare on the same axes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

CORE CLAIM

- GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence
- MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

MECHANISM

- AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga
- RULE → compare on the same axes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence
- MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga; RULE → compare on the same axes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares.

03

STAGE 03 THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

GREY STONE, BUDDHIST, LAYERED INFLUENCE

RED STONE, THREE RELIGIONS, ATTRIBUTES

LIMESTONE, BUDDHIST NARRATIVE, TRIBHANGA

COMPARE ON THE SAME AXES

CORE CLAIM

GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

MECHANISM

AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga

RULE → compare on the same axes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

CORE CLAIM

• GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

• MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

MECHANISM

• AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga

• RULE → compare on the same axes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

• MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga; RULE → compare on the same axes.

04

STAGE 04 ANICONIC TO ICONIC

ANICONIC TO ICONIC

EMPTY THRONE

SYMBOLIC PRESENCE

DEVOTIONAL CHANGE

HUMAN IMAGE BECOMES CENTRAL

GANDHARA + MATHURA

OVERLAPPING EARLY-CE CONTEXTS

NO UNCONTESTED SOLE ORIGIN

EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence

DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts

CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin

CORE CLAIM

• EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence

• DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

MECHANISM

• GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts

• CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence

• DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence.

05

STAGE 05 GUPTA BRIDGE

GUPTA BRIDGE

CREAM SANDSTONE

SUBTLE MODELLING AND THIN DRAPERY

LATE OR POST-GUPTA CAUTION

RESTRAINT BEFORE DENSER TEMPLE PROGRAMMES

CORE CLAIM

SARNATH → cream sandstone

BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

MECHANISM

SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution

BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

SARNATH → cream sandstone

BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

CORE CLAIM

• SARNATH → cream sandstone

• BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

MECHANISM

• SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution

• BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• SARNATH → cream sandstone

• BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution; BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes.

06

STAGE 06 NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT

CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE

TEMPLE PROCESSION

RITUAL MOBILITY

PEAK IS NOT ORIGIN

AIHOLE → early known antecedent

CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility

RULE → peak is not origin

CORE CLAIM

• AIHOLE → early known antecedent

• CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

MECHANISM

• TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility

• RULE → peak is not origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• AIHOLE → early known antecedent

• CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07 NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

06

STAGE 06 NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE TEMPLE PROCESSION RITUAL MOBILITY PEAK IS NOT ORIGIN



CORE CLAIM

- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

MECHANISM

- TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility
- RULE → peak is not origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

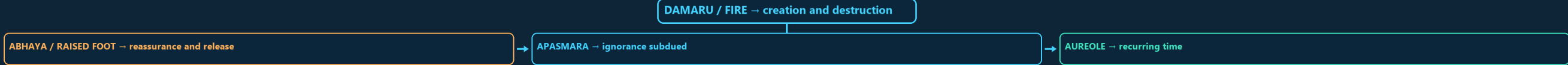
- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07 NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP CREATION AND DESTRUCTION RAISED FOOT REASSURANCE AND RELEASE IGNORANCE SUBDUED RECURRING TIME



CORE CLAIM

- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

MECHANISM

- APASMARA → ignorance subdued
- AUREOLE → recurring time

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release.

08

STAGE 08 LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER

LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER BULL VISIBLE, MEANING UNRECOVERABLE INSCRIBED LION, UNINSCRIBED BULL ANIMALS INSIDE A BUDDHIST-IMPERIAL SYSTEM NANDI, YALI AND VYALA GAIN PLACED ROLES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable	SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system	HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull	TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles	RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull
CORE CLAIM • HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable • RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull	MECHANISM • SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system • TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable • RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles.

09

STAGE 09 TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT AXIAL PAVILION BEFORE SHIVA COMPOSITE GUARDIAN ON SOUTHERN PILLARS LION-BODIED HYBRID AT KHAJURAHO BUILDING, GUARDIAN AND MOTIF

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva	VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho	NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva
YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars
CORE CLAIM • NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva • YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	MECHANISM • VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho • DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva • YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho; DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif.

09

STAGE 09 TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT AXIAL PAVILION BEFORE SHIVA COMPOSITE GUARDIAN ON SOUTHERN PILLARS LION-BODIED HYBRID AT KHAJURAHO BUILDING, GUARDIAN AND MOTIF

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars
CORE CLAIM • NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva • YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	MECHANISM • VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho • DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva • YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho; DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif.

10

STAGE 10 SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST

SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST DANCER, MUSICIAN, TEACHER OR COUPLE SELECTED WHAT BECAME VISIBLE VALUED ACTIVITY OR RITUAL IDIOM NOT A CENSUS OF SOCIETY

FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple

PATRON → selected what became visible	CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom	LIMIT → not a census of society
CORE CLAIM • FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple • PATRON → selected what became visible	MECHANISM • CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom • LIMIT → not a census of society	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple • PATRON → selected what became visible

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom; LIMIT → not a census of society.

11

STAGE 11 SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE

SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE SCHOOL, OBJECT OR SYMBOL MATERIAL, POSTURE, ATTRIBUTE AND SITE PERIOD OR REGIONAL WORKSHOP ATTRIBUTION, PRIORITY AND SOCIAL INFERENCE

DEFINE → school, object or symbol	EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site	COMPARE → period or regional workshop	QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference
CORE CLAIM • DEFINE → school, object or symbol • EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site	MECHANISM • COMPARE → period or regional workshop • QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • DEFINE → school, object or symbol • EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → period or regional workshop; QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT NO URGENT CURRENT-STATUS CORRECTION IS REQUIRED FOR THIS TOPIC'S TREATING CHOLA PATRONAGE AS THE ORIGIN OF NATARAJA ICONOGRAPHY. TREATING "INDO-GREEK" (GANDHARA) AS MEANING THE SCULPTURE IS ASSUMING ICONOGRAPHIC ATTRIBUTE IDENTIFICATION ALWAYS OVER-RIDES TREATING TRADITIONAL MUSEUM LABELS AS DECODED HARAPPAN IDENTITIES. ASSIGNING DIDARGANJ AUTOMATICALLY TO THE MAURYAS. - ITS POLISH TOPIC 13 OWNS THE DOCTRINAL/THEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH • No urgent current-status correction is required for this topic's • NOT: Treating Chola patronage as the origin of Nataraja iconography. - The • NOT: Treating "Indo-Greek" (Gandhara) as meaning the sculpture is • NOT: Assuming iconographic attribute identification always over-rides	ATTRIBUTION / INTERPRETIVE LIMIT • NOT: Treating traditional museum labels as decoded Harappan identities. • NOT: Assigning Didarganj automatically to the Mauryas. - Its polish supports • NOT: Topic 13 owns the doctrinal/theological significance of • NOT: Ancient/Medieval History owns the political chronology of the	COMPARATIVE HERITAGE NUANCE • This file's six-factor method is directly reusable for topic 03's • Foundation companion: basic/06 Sculpture-Pottery-and-Iconography.md. • 00 Master-Framework.md Section 2 — the "how to read a monument, • CAUTION: Cross-links: Topic 03 (Chandella sculptural-programme dossier,
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OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.